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ENDORSED
FILED
Superior Court of California
County of San Francisco
JUL 09 2018
CLERK OF THE COURT
KELLY DAVIES
By: Deputy Clerk

SUPERIOR COURT OF THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA
COUNTY OF SAN FRANCISCO

In re the Matter of
Petitioner: STEPHEN RUSSELL
and
Respondent: TARA WALSH

CASE NO.: FTP-18-377425
DECLARATION OF ABREHET TEDLA
Date: July 10, 2018
Time: 1:30 p.m.
Dept: 404
Judge: Richard C. Darwin

I, Abrehet "Abby" Tedla, declare and state:

1. My name is Abby Tedla and from March 6 of this year to very recently, I was Evelyn (Evie) Grace Walsh's nanny and primary caregiver. I lived with Mr. Stephen Russell and Ms. Tara Walsh at their home at 301 Mission street.
2. First, I'd like to say that I love Evie and she was very well taken care of in San Francisco. In addition to myself, Evie's father, and sometimes staff also helped with Evie. Their home was very nice and well taken care of in one of the nicest buildings in San Francisco, and Mr. Russell had retained one of the top pediatricians in the city for Evie, and Ms. Walsh as well from a concierge medical group called Private Medical.
3. Tara moved to California from New York in March of this year. I was initially hired for a one-month contract to spend nights with the baby, but that was later expanded to

1 include much of the day too. Tara's medication prevented her from being able to take
2 care of the baby at night, especially before Evie was able to generally sleep through
3 the whole night. My understanding from both Mr. Russell and Ms. Walsh was that
4 they intended to live in San Francisco going forward. Ms. Walsh purchased clothes,
5 furniture, baby goods, changed her address, received mail, and began seeing doctors
6 here. I was asked to continue on and I am currently on the payroll for the next 2 ½
7 months.

- 8 4. I have never seen Mr. Russell be abusive to Ms. Walsh in any way and I do not
9 believe this to be his nature. I have seen Ms. Walsh regularly verbally abuse Mr.
10 Russell, however, but Mr. Russell was always patient and kind to her. I have
11 witnessed Ms. Walsh yell and call Mr. Russell names such as "old, fat, asshole". Due
12 to the ongoing verbal assaults to Mr. Russell, I once asked him "how do you do it?" I
13 have never seen someone deal so well with another person being so verbally abusive.
14 In fact, I contacted Mr. Crutcher at times and advised him to remove Mr. Russell
15 from the situation as I felt so bad for him.
- 16 5. Ms. Walsh told me she took prescription sleeping pills at night prior to going to
17 bedtime and was unable to care for Evie during the night.
- 18 6. On one occasion, on 5/15/2018, I took Evie for a walk with Ms. Walsh's permission.
19 After returning from our daily walk with Evie, Ms. Walsh was yelling and extremely
20 irate. She accused me of trying to take her baby away. Feeling hurt, confused and
21 afraid by her false accusations of trying to kidnap Evie, I left the apartment and
22 started towards the elevator. Moments later, I heard through the closed door Evie
23 screaming. Concerned for Evie's safety I rushed back to see if she was Ok. Tara said
24 Evie had rolled off the bed accidentally. Evie had a bump and red bruise on her head
25 and I was asked to help get the baby to the hospital. After seeing the doctor, it was
26 determined she was fine, thankfully.
- 27 7. Ms. Walsh had been putting drugs in his drinks without his knowledge and she had
28 asked me to lie and tell social services that he was a bad dad/person. Once Ms. Walsh

1 realized I was not going to lie for her or condone her mistreatment and drugging of
2 Mr. Russell, she began to treat me with disdain and ultimately fired me. One time after
3 I had told Mr. Russell about her drugging him, she yelled, "I hate that fucking
4 nanny!" On one occasion she told me she was "bipolar". I regret not informing Mr.
5 Russell right away about her putting the pills in his wine, but I did not understand
6 exactly what was happening.

7 8. I commonly worked as her nanny 18-22 hours a day, seven days a week; apparently
8 working via her computer or enjoying her free time doing other things. I have heard
9 Mr. Russell offer to pay her to do projects for him after she complained that she did
10 not have any money.

11 9. I saw her drug him on at least two occasions; however she told me and Dan Ochoa
12 that she "did it all the time." This caused me to fear for Mr. Russell's safety and I saw
13 the effects on those two occasions after he drank the tainted wine. It appeared to
14 cause him to lose consciousness shortly after. Once, when Tara's friend was visiting,
15 I threw away any open containers of food in case maybe Tara had added it to other
16 food or drink in the house. I also told Bryan to tell Steve not to drink anything. That
17 night I threw away the leftover food. That was the only time I threw away food. I
18 wasn't otherwise concerned for my safety.

19 10. Mr. Russell gave me 3-month severance and asked that I consider helping in case of
20 an emergency. Ms. Walsh had just then agreed to see a new Psychiatrist after another
21 incident where she believed she saw Mr. Russell was running around with a gun,
22 which didn't happen. When she realized that was a delusion, she called her mother
23 and doctor who said Ms. Walsh needed an immediate medical intervention and
24 delusions like this had happened in the past.

25 11. Mr. Russell seemed genuinely committed to helping Tara and was hopeful that with
26 treatment she might get better.

27 12. I love Evie and only want what is best for her. She had a very good home in San
28 Francisco and many people who cared for her. Tara was difficult, but I believe this is

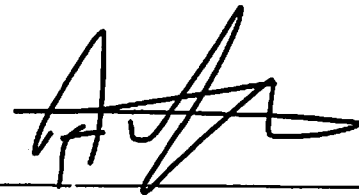
1 part of her mental illness, and in reality Mr. Russell does want her to get better. Mr.
2 Russell is a good person who provided for everything Ms. Walsh and baby needed
3 and had many close family and staff nearby. Even though Ms. Walsh fired me twice, I
4 came back because of Evie who is the happiest baby I have ever seen in my entire
5 life.

6 13. My last act for Ms. Walsh and Mr. Russell was to help Ms. Walsh and the baby visit
7 Ms. Walsh's parents. I was not present when this happened, but I heard that in the
8 previous two weeks, Ms. Walsh had tried to secretly leave the state first by herself
9 and then with the baby. On the second occasion, Mr. Russell took emergency action
10 and received a court order to keep Evie in the state until a mediation hearing. But, Mr.
11 Russell also thought a 2-3 week break might be helpful to Ms. Walsh. So, he agreed
12 to let her visit her parents in NY if she would agree to stay at her parents' house and
13 return home in 2-3 weeks. Tara agreed. I flew with Ms. Walsh and the baby and saw
14 her father pick them up at the airport. I then stayed the night in a hotel and flew back
15 the next day.

16 14. Since that time, my only conversations with Tara have been pleasantries. I did not
17 expect her to stay in NY or make the accusations she has.

18 15. I declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the State of California that the
19 foregoing is true and correct.

20
21 Dated: 7/6/2018



22 Abby Tedla
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